- *Elastic Load Balancing (ELB)*—AWS offers a load balancer as a service. The load balancer distributes traffic to a bunch of virtual machines and is highly available by default. Requests are routed to virtual machines as long as their health check succeeds. You'll use the Application Load Balancer (ALB), which operates on layer 7 (HTTP and HTTPS).
- *Elastic Compute Cloud (EC2)*—The EC2 service provides virtual machines. You'll use a Linux machine with an optimized distribution called Amazon Linux to install Apache, PHP, and WordPress. You aren't limited to Amazon Linux; you could also choose Ubuntu, Debian, Red Hat, or Windows. Virtual machines can fail, so you need at least two of them. The load balancer will distribute the traffic between them. In case a virtual machine fails, the load balancer will stop sending traffic to the failed VM, and the remaining VM will need to handle all requests until the failed VM is replaced.
- *Relational Database Service (RDS) for MySQL*—WordPress relies on the popular MySQL database. AWS provides MySQL with its RDS. You choose the database size (storage, CPU, RAM), and RDS takes over operating tasks like creating backups and installing patches and updates. RDS can also provide a highly available MySQL database using replication.
- *Elastic File System (EFS)*—WordPress itself consists of PHP and other application files. User uploads—for example, images added to an article—are stored as files as well. By using a network filesystem, your virtual machines can access these files. EFS provides a scalable, highly available, and durable network filesystem using the NFSv4.1 protocol.